The Logistics of the Cross: Medical Reality, Intervention, and the Yielding of Empire

Sermon for Shabbat and Sunday
Readings drawn from the Institute for Scripture Research (ISR) Scriptures

To the Fleet and Command Staff,
Today we are stripping away centuries of mystical overlay to examine the crucifixion through the lens of historical precedent, medical reality, and operational logistics. We are looking at the greatest extraction operation in the history of the Vanguard.

To understand the reality of what happened at Golgotha **(John 19:17 - "Carrying his own cross, he went out to the place of the Skull, which in Aramaic is called Golgotha")**, we must look at the accepted historical intelligence of the era.

I. The Historical Precedent of Survival

Crucifixion was designed to be an execution, but military and historical records prove it was not an absolute biological finality if intercepted in time. The Jewish historian Flavius Josephus recorded a highly classified operational reality in his autobiography. During the siege of Jerusalem, Josephus recognized three of his acquaintances hanging on crosses. He used his rank and influence to immediately petition the Roman commander, Titus, for their release.

Titus issued the order. The men were taken down early and immediately handed over to Roman military physicians for intensive medical care. While two succumbed to their injuries, one man—a standard human captive—survived the cross through sheer medical intervention.

This is the historical baseline. Survival was mathematically and biologically possible if three conditions were met: early extraction, immense political influence, and immediate, elite medical care.

II. The King's Extraction Operation

If a standard captive could survive through the intervention of a historian, we must apply this operational logic to the King of Israel.

Jesus was not a random casualty. The Romans themselves nailed His official title to the cross: ***Iesus Nazarenus, Rex Iudaeorum*** **INRI (John 19:19 - "Pilate had a notice prepared and fastened to the cross. It read: Jesus of Nazareth, the King of the Jews")**. He was a highly valued target, but He was also protected by highly placed operatives.

When it was time to move, the Vanguard executed a precise intervention. Joseph of Arimathea—a wealthy, highly influential member of the ruling council—stepped forward. He used his political leverage to petition Pilate directly for the body, ensuring an early extraction **(Mark 15:43 - "Joseph of Arimathea, a prominent member of the Council, who was himself waiting for the kingdom of God, went boldly to Pilate and asked for Jesus' body")**. Alongside Nicodemus, who brought a massive logistical supply of medicinal myrrh and aloes—seventy-five pounds of it **(John 19:39)**—they removed Jesus from the Roman theater of operations.

They did not place Him in a shallow grave. They moved Him into a secure, newly hewn rock tomb—a fortified location consistent with Israel's advanced subterranean networks and heavy rolling stone doors **(Matthew 27:60 - "and rolled a big stone in front of the entrance to the tomb")**. Behind that stone, in a secure environment safe from Roman patrols, the King was attended to. If a random captive could be saved by Roman medics, the Vanguard—possessing the greatest healers, the knowledge of the Essenes, and the absolute mandate of Elohim—had the full capability to treat, stabilize, and secure their Commander.

III. The Doctrine of Absolute Atonement

Why is this operational reality so critical for us today? Because it establishes the ultimate law of accountability and atonement.

Rome and the local authorities put everything they had into executing a man whose only crime was teaching advanced moral philosophy, feeding the starving **(Matthew 14:14-21)**, and utilizing advanced medical knowledge to heal the crippled **(Matthew 15:30 - "Great crowds came to him, bringing the lame, the blind, the crippled, the mute and many others, and laid them at his feet; and he healed them")**. They were fundamentally, catastrophically wrong.

When you are wrong—even if you are an empire, even if you have already initiated lethal force—the moment you realize you have struck the truth, you must halt. You must atone. Rome authorized the execution, but when the Vanguard proved that the King could not be defeated, the empire experienced a massive system shock. You cannot sweep the truth under the rug. Imagine if Joseph of Arimathea had lacked the courage to intervene. Imagine if the Vanguard had allowed Rome to cover up the injustice.

Instead, the truth survived. And because it survived, the Roman Empire ultimately had to do the unthinkable: they had to yield command. The empire that ordered His execution eventually bowed to His authority, putting their entire infrastructure into printing His texts and spreading His word **(Philippians 2:9-11 - "Therefore God exalted him to the highest place... that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth")**.

When someone is right, and you are wrong, you must yield the chain of command to them until you are reliable enough to lead again. Rome had to yield to the King.
We must operate with this exact same integrity. When we are wrong, we atone **(1 John 1:9 - "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness")**. When we find the truth, we defend it. And we never leave our people behind enemy lines.
Hold the line. The King survives.

References:

Document: Mary removed Jesus from the cross as a form of intervention

- *1-XFUix2jUE* [Video]. (n.d.). YouTube. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1-XFUix2jUE
- *Back in her arms.* (2024, March 20). Catholic Girl Journey. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://catholicgirljourney.org/2024/03/20/back-in-her-arms/
- *Descent from the Cross.* (n.d.). Wikipedia. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Descent_from_the_Cross
- *The 13th station…* (n.d.). Facebook / Her View From Home. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.facebook.com/HerViewFromHome/posts/the-…
- *Untitled post.* (n.d.). Facebook. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.facebook.com/groups/1651829551783512/posts/3997563140543463/
- *Were you there? Mary stood.* (2017, April). Franciscan Mission Service. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://franciscanmissionservice.org/2017/04/were-you-there-mary-stood/

Document: Jesus was the King of Israel according to inscription INRI

- *At the top of many crucifixes are the letters INRI…* (n.d.). Facebook / Father Cedric. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.facebook.com/FatherCedric/posts/at-the-top-of-many-crucifixes-are-the-letters-inri-they-are-the-abbreviation-for/1371995254284996/
- *Jesus, King of the Jews.* (n.d.). Wikipedia. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jesus,_King_of_the_Jews
- *The meaning of INRI on the cross of Jesus.* (n.d.). Holyart. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.holyart.com/blog/religious-items/the-meaning-of-inri-on-the-cross-of-jesus/
- *What does INRI stand for?* (n.d.). 412teens. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://412teens.org/qna/what-does-INRI-stand-for.php
- *Why was INRI written on the cross of Jesus Christ…* [Video]. (n.d.). Facebook / Lister Lili Kazoka. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.facebook.com/lister.lili.kazoka/videos/why-was-inri-written-on-the-cross-of-jesus-christ-inri-jesuschristkingofthejewsc/1624439798…

Document: Israel ancient tunnel network rolling doors

- *1-XFUix2jUE* [Video]. (n.d.). YouTube. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1-XFUix2jUE
- *No one knew this door existed.* (n.d.). The Archaeologist. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.thearchaeologist.org/blog/no-one-knew-this-door-existed
- *RMUnjJI5s8I* [Video]. (n.d.). YouTube. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RMUnjJI5s8I
- *The true history of ancient Jewish underground…* (2024, January 18). Haaretz. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.haaretz.com/archaeology/2024-01-18/ty-article/the-true-history-of-ancient-jewish-underground…

Document: How many associated with Jesus were medical healers?

- *A data analysis of healing in the Bible*. (n.d.). Ed Melick. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.edmelick.com/test-page-blog/a-data-analysis-of-healing-in-the-bible
- *Christ the healer: Jesus sends his disciples to heal in his name*. (2016, June). Dominican Friars Province of St. Joseph. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://opeast.org/2016/06/christ-the-healer-jesus-sends-his-disciples-to-heal-in-his-name/
- *Healing ministries…* (2021, March). Michael Adam Beck. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://michaeladambeck.com/2021/03/…
- *Jesus the healer*. (n.d.). Christian History Institute. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://christianhistoryinstitute.org/magazine/article/jesus-the-healer-ch-142

Document: How many associated with Jesus were medical doctors?

- *October 18 is remembered as the feast of St. Luke…* (n.d.). Facebook / EWTN. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.facebook.com/ewtnonline/posts/october-18-is-remembered-as-the-feast-of-st-luke-the-physician-and-companion-of-/1174507400702466/
- *Physician*. (n.d.). BiblicalTraining.org. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.biblicaltraining.org/library/physician
- *Saint Luke was born a Greek and a Gentile…* (n.d.). Facebook / New Kensington Catholic. Retrieved April 14, 2026, from https://www.facebook.com/NewKensingtonCatholic/posts/saint-luke-was-born-a-greek-and-a-gentile-in-antioch-syria-he-was-a-physician-an/2688297104721232/

Dr. Correo "Cory" Andrew Hofstad Med Sci. Educ, PO, ND, DO, PharmD, OEM, GPM, Psych, MD, JSD, JD, SEP, MPH, PhD, MBA/COGS, MLSCM, MDiv

Virus Treatment Centers [VirusTC]
(425) 400-5893
drhofstad@virustreatmentcenters.com